

CORN *Zea mays*

Corn grows easily in warm regions, but good crops are possible in cooler areas if seed is sown under cover. Standard or sugary (su) varieties have been largely supplanted by supersweet (Sh2) corn, which retains its very sweet flavor after picking. Sugar enhanced types (se) are also very sweet, and widely grown; hybrid synergistic corn combines traits from both. Baby corn can be grown on closely spaced plants or by using special varieties.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Any fertile garden soil in full sun is suitable. Dig in plenty of well-rotted manure before planting, and supplement this with an application of balanced liquid fertilizer. Add lime, too, if soils are acidic. Being wind pollinated, it is best raised in squares rather than rows.

Raise early crops by sowing seed under cover, two seeds per small container, at a depth of 1–1.5 in (2.5–4 cm), keeping them at a minimum temperature of 70–80°F (20–27°C). Seedlings can be singled out once they have started to develop. Plant them out in late spring or early summer, and protect them with cloches or fleece if the weather is cold. Ensure that plants have



Plant out seedlings from late spring.

enough space—about 16 in (40 cm) between plants in the case of full-sized corn. Where baby corn is being grown, allow 6 in (15 cm) between plants, and 12 in (30 cm) between rows.

If sowing directly into the ground, wait until days are warm and night temperatures are above 50°F (10°C). Sow three seeds for each plant and thin out later, if required. Subsequent crops can be